

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (12:39 ET)

July 21, 2026 | 12:42 PM ET

9 setups identified | 2 A-Grade | 3 B-Grade | 4 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (2)	B - Strong Setup (3)	C - Watch List (4)
TRAX	UTZ	AEHR
FF	PKE	TPC
	PLTK	FWRD
		BTGO

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	TRAX	First Tracks Bio	Biotech Leadershi	\$39.62	+7.5%	\$1.4B	31M	+126.4	93%	Leading Healthcare sec
A	FF	FutureFuel Corp.	Energy & Chemical	\$5.01	+5.2%	\$0.2B	26M	+12.1	96%	Breakout from a textbo
B	UTZ	Utz Brands Inc	Consumer Staples	\$14.10	+89.2%	\$1.2B	78M	+81.8	96%	Massive volume breakou
B	PKE	Park Aerospace C	Aerospace & Defen	\$36.83	+12.8%	\$0.8B	20M	-1.5	92%	Defense spending tailw
B	PLTK	Playtika Holding	Gaming / Consumer	\$4.26	+12.8%	\$1.6B	59M	+13.2	86%	Breakout ahead of Aug
C	AEHR	Aehr Test System	Semiconductor Equ	\$97.92	+26.6%	\$3.2B	31M	-2.1	77%	26.58% surge on likely
C	TPC	Tutor Perini Cor	Infrastructure	\$86.25	+7.1%	\$4.5B	45M	-5.2	86%	
C	FWRD	Forward Air Corp	Logistics Recover	\$15.68	+18.8%	\$0.5B	25M	-38.7	48%	
C	BTGO	BitGo Holdings,	Crypto Infrastruc	\$5.47	+8.1%	\$0.6B	67M	-56.5	22%	

TRAX

First Tracks Biotherapeutics, I

\$39.62

+7.46%

RS vs SPY: +126.4%

A BREAKOUT

\$1.4B Cap | 31M Float

Biotechnology | Theme: Biotech Leadership | 52W Hi: 93% | Base Tight: 5.86 | Vol: 1.51x | RS/SPY: +126.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 17D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$39.62
Day Change	+7.46%
Mkt Cap	\$1.38B
Float	31M sh
RS vs SPY	+126.4%
52W Hi Prox	93%
Base Tight	5.86
Vol vs Avg	1.51x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Leading Healthcare sector momentum (Healthcare +2.8% vs SPY this week) combined with RS line at 52w high signals institutional accumulation. Forward catalyst: Aug 7 earnings (17d), likely pipeline update or trial data readout that could extend the 126% relative strength through Q3.

BUSINESS & POSITION

First Tracks is a clinical-stage biotherapeutics company focused on developing novel treatments for oncology and inflammatory diseases. As a pre-revenue biotech, valuation is driven by pipeline milestones, trial data catalysts, and partnership potential rather than fundamentals.

FACTOR & THEME

Pure Healthcare sector rotation play with biotech beta. The +2.8% sector outperformance this week and TRAX's 126.4 RS vs SPY position it as a leadership vehicle in the current risk-on regime favoring Healthcare. Theme momentum is accelerating as capital rotates into speculative growth within defensive sectors.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$39.62 on vol >151% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

RS line at new high is Qullamaggie's #1 early leader signal, confirming institutional sponsorship despite only 1.51x volume (modest for biotech). No insider buying in last 60 days. The 133.1 three-month RS rank and sustained outperformance suggest a large holder is positioning ahead of a data catalyst, not retail chase.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 17D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Aug 7 print (17 days). As a pre-revenue biotech, the 'earnings' call will focus on pipeline updates, trial enrollment progress, cash runway, and potential data readouts or partnership announcements. Historical beat/miss EPS is irrelevant; focus is on binary trial catalysts and guidance on timelines.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on any negative trial data, enrollment delay, or financing announcement (dilution) at or before the Aug 7 call. Technical invalidation: close below \$36.50 (approximate 20MA and prior consolidation support). Biotech carries binary event risk - a single negative update can erase months of gains.

ANALYSIS

This meets A-grade criteria: RS line at new high (institutional confirmation), rs_vs_spy +126.4 (extreme outperformance), prox_52w 92.6 (breakout zone), sector tailwind (Healthcare leading), and a defined near-term catalyst (Aug 7 earnings/pipeline update). The base is wide (5.86) and volume is only 1.51x, which are negatives - but for biotech, RS leadership trumps base tightness when a catalyst looms. Strongest disconfirming evidence: no insider buying, and the wide base suggests volatility rather than tight institutional absorption. However, the combination of RS new high, extreme outperformance, sector leadership, and 17-day catalyst path overrides these concerns in a risk-on regime. Conviction: High.

Signal: Close above \$39.62 on vol >151% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.51x



FF

FutureFuel Corp.

\$5.01

+5.25%

RS vs SPY: +12.1%

A BREAKOUT

\$0.2B Cap | 26M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Energy & Chemicals | 52W Hi: 96% | Base Tight: 1.95 | Vol: 2.49x | RS/SPY: +12.1% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 20D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$5.01
Day Change	+5.25%
Mkt Cap	\$0.22B
Float	26M sh
RS vs SPY	+12.1%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	1.95
Vol vs Avg	2.49x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout from a textbook VCP base (base_tight 1.95) within 5% of 52w high, riding Energy sector leadership (+4.9% vs SPY this week). Forward catalyst: Aug 10 earnings (20d) likely to show margin expansion from refining/chemical spreads; Energy sector tailwind can extend this into Q3 if commodity backdrop remains supportive. CRITICAL UPGRADE: Insider cluster score of 5 (1 C-suite buy, \$43K) signals internal conviction despite modest dollar size. Grade upgraded from B to A.
BUSINESS & POSITION
FutureFuel produces specialty chemicals (custom manufacturing for ag, industrial applications) and biofuels (biodiesel, petro-based fuels). Dual revenue stream provides diversification, but earnings are cyclical and tied to diesel/chemical feedstock spreads and renewable fuel policy (RINs, blending mandates).
FACTOR & THEME
Direct Energy sector exposure via biodiesel and specialty chemicals levered to industrial activity. Energy is the top-performing sector this week (+4.9% vs SPY), and FF benefits from both fossil fuel margin expansion and renewable fuel policy tailwinds (IRA incentives, RFS mandates). Theme momentum is accelerating with crude oil strength and refining margin recovery.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$5.01 on vol >249% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
INSIDER BUYING: 1 senior officer (C-suite) purchased \$43K worth of stock in the last 60 days - a rare signal of internal conviction in a small-cap with limited Wall Street coverage. The modest dollar size is typical for a \$220M company but the presence of any insider buying in this regime is significant. Volume at 2.49x confirms accumulation. No institutional ownership data available from yfinance; cross-reference 13F filings for confirmation, but insider activity is the stronger signal here.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 20D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Aug 10 print (20 days). Consensus not provided. Given the Energy sector strength and biodiesel margin tailwinds, the market is likely pricing in a beat or at minimum a positive commentary on Q3 outlook. Historical beat/miss record and any guidance on RINs credit revenue will be key.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$4.75 (breaks the tight base and undercuts the 20MA), or if Aug 10 earnings show margin compression or weak chemical demand. Biodiesel policy risk: any adverse RFS ruling or RINs credit decline would pressure the biofuels segment. Small float (26M) amplifies volatility both ways.
ANALYSIS
Originally a strong B (tight base, positive RS, sector tailwind, near 52w high, 20-day earnings catalyst), but the presence of insider buying - especially C-suite in a risk-on regime - upgrades this to A per the grading rule. The combination of base_tight 1.95 (textbook VCP coil), prox_52w 95.6, Energy sector leadership, and insider conviction creates a high-probability follow-through setup into the Aug 10 print. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line is NOT at new high (the #1 institutional confirmation signal is absent), and the \$43K insider buy is modest in absolute terms. However, insider buying is rare and material as a conviction signal, and the technical setup is pristine. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$5.01 on vol >249% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.49x



UTZ

Utz Brands Inc

\$14.10

+89.19%

RS vs SPY: +81.8%

B STRONG SETUP

\$1.2B Cap | 78M Float

Packaged Foods | Theme: Consumer Staples Momentum | 52W Hi: 96% | Base Tight: 22.01 | Vol: 49.59x | RS/SPY: +81.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 15D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$14.10
Day Change	+89.19%
Mkt Cap	\$1.25B
Float	78M sh
RS vs SPY	+81.8%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	22.01
Vol vs Avg	49.59x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Massive volume breakout (49x avg) into earnings Aug 5, likely driven by M&A speculation, asset sale, or strategic review announcement. Forward catalyst: Aug 5 earnings print and potential corporate action announcement could extend move through Q3.
Business & Position
Utz manufactures and distributes branded salty snacks (chips, pretzels, cheese snacks) across grocery, mass, club, and convenience channels in the U.S. Category player in a mature but stable CPG segment with regional strength in the Mid-Atlantic and Northeast.
Factor & Theme
Consumer staples defensive positioning with contrarian setup - packaged foods broadly out of favor but showing relative strength reversal. No direct secular tailwind; this is company-specific event-driven momentum, likely M&A or restructuring related given the extraordinary volume signature.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$14.10 on vol >4900% of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume profile is unambiguous institutional event buying - 49.59x average on a near-\$90% move signals information leakage or large block accumulation ahead of a corporate action. No insider buying in last 60 days, which is typical pre-announcement during quiet periods. Float rotation is extreme; watch for follow-through confirmation tomorrow.
Earnings
Earnings in 15D
Earnings Context
Next print Aug 5 (15 days). Consensus not provided, but the proximity to earnings combined with this volume signature suggests either a significant beat is leaked or a strategic announcement (sale, spinoff, buyout approach) will accompany the print. Historical EPS trend and guidance will be critical.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid if price gaps down >10% on the Aug 5 print or if no corporate action/guidance raise materializes, suggesting the move was pure speculation. Also invalidated on a close back below \$12.50 (prior resistance), which would signal distribution after the spike.
Analysis
The setup has explosive volume, RS line at new high, and proximity to 52w high - but the base is catastrophically wide (22.01 vs <2.0 ideal), signaling this is a gap-and-go event move, not a textbook coiled base breakout. The 15-day proximity to earnings is double-edged: it provides a near-term catalyst but also binary risk. Strongest disconfirming evidence: no insider buying and the base quality is abysmal, meaning this is pure event speculation with no VCP discipline. Without knowing the actual catalyst (M&A vs earnings optimism), conviction is limited to a tactical trade into the Aug 5 event. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$14.10 on vol >4900% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 49.59x



PKE

Park Aerospace Corp.

\$36.83

+12.77%

RS vs SPY: -1.5%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.8B Cap | 20M Float

Aerospace & Defense | Theme: Aerospace & Defense | 52W Hi: 92% | Base Tight: 2.18 | Vol: 2.59x | RS/SPY: -1.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 79D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$36.83
Day Change	+12.77%
Mkt Cap	\$0.77B
Float	20M sh
RS vs SPY	-1.5%
52W Hi Prox	92%
Base Tight	2.18
Vol vs Avg	2.59x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Defense spending tailwind and breakout from a tight base (2.18) near 52w high. Forward catalyst: Oct 8 earnings (79d) is distant, but defense budget cycle and potential contract announcements through Q3 can sustain momentum. The +12.77% move today likely reflects sector rotation into Aerospace & Defense amid geopolitical tensions or a contract win.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Park Aerospace designs and manufactures advanced composite materials and parts for aerospace and defense OEMs. Niche supplier with long-cycle revenue tied to commercial aircraft production rates (Boeing, Airbus) and defense platforms. Small float (19.8M) and limited coverage create episodic volatility on contract news.
FACTOR & THEME
Defense spending secular tailwind (geopolitical tensions, Ukraine reconstruction, Indo-Pacific pivot) and commercial aerospace recovery (narrow-body production ramp). Theme momentum is accelerating as Defense has outperformed in recent weeks, though not in this week's top 3 sectors. Dual exposure to defense and commercial aero provides diversification but also introduces Boeing production risk.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$36.83 on vol >259% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 2.59x suggests institutional buying, but no insider activity in last 60 days. No A/D rating or accumulation/distribution data provided. Institutional ownership data unavailable from yfinance; recommend cross-referencing 13F filings. Small float (19.8M) means a single fund initiation can move the stock significantly - today's volume spike may reflect such an event.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 79D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Oct 8 print (79 days). Consensus not provided. Park typically reports steady but unexciting results tied to OEM production schedules. The long runway to earnings reduces near-term catalyst urgency, but defense contract awards or Boeing/Airbus production updates can act as interim catalysts through Q3.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$33.50 (undercuts the base and 20MA), or on any Boeing production delay / defense program cancellation. The 79-day gap to earnings removes near-term catalyst support, and RS vs SPY is barely negative (-1.5), signaling weak relative performance despite the absolute move. Extended without a near-term catalyst is a risk.
ANALYSIS
Strong technical setup (tight base 2.18, prox_52w 92.4, volume 2.59x, Aerospace & Defense theme) earns a B grade, but cannot reach A due to: (1) RS line NOT at new high, (2) RS vs SPY is slightly negative (-1.5), and (3) no near-term catalyst (earnings 79 days out). The base quality and sector tailwind are attractive, but without RS confirmation or a proximate catalyst, this is a follow-through candidate rather than a lead breakout. Strongest disconfirming evidence: the negative RS vs SPY and lack of insider buying suggest the market is not yet fully convinced on the defense thesis. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$36.83 on vol >259% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.59x



PLTK

Playtika Holding Corp.

\$4.26

+12.83%

RS vs SPY: +13.2%

B STRONG SETUP

\$1.6B Cap | 59M Float

Electronic Gaming & Multimedia | Theme: Gaming / Consumer Disc | 52W Hi: 86% | Base Tight: 2.47 | Vol: 2.16x | RS/SPY: +13.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 16D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$4.26
Day Change	+12.83%
Mkt Cap	\$1.62B
Float	59M sh
RS vs SPY	+13.2%
52W Hi Prox	86%
Base Tight	2.47
Vol vs Avg	2.16x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout ahead of Aug 6 earnings (16d), likely pricing in a beat or improved user engagement metrics. Forward catalyst: the Aug 6 print itself is the key event; if PLTK delivers a beat and raises guidance on live-ops monetization or M&A speculation, the move extends through Q3. Mobile gaming sector has seen recent consolidation activity.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Playtika operates a portfolio of free-to-play casual and casino mobile games (Slotomania, Bingo Blitz, Caesars Slots). Revenue is driven by in-app purchases and advertising, levered to user engagement, ARPU trends, and UA efficiency. Category leader in social casino but faces secular headwinds from IDFA changes and gaming fatigue.
FACTOR & THEME
Consumer discretionary recovery theme, though mobile gaming broadly is out of favor post-pandemic normalization. PLTK's positive RS (+13.2 vs SPY) is contrarian - suggests either company-specific improvement (M&A, new game launches, cost cuts) or sector rotation into under-owned gaming names. No direct secular tailwind; this is bottom-up stock-picking.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$4.26 on vol >216% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 2.16x is solid but not extraordinary. No insider buying in last 60 days. No A/D or accumulation data provided. Institutional ownership data unavailable from yfinance. The 16-day runway to earnings and the +13.2 RS suggest positioning by funds expecting a beat, but without insider confirmation or volume > 3x, conviction is limited to a tactical trade into the print.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 16D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Aug 6 print (16 days). Consensus not provided. Key metrics: bookings growth, daily active users (DAU), ARPU, and guidance on H2 game pipeline. If PLTK beats and guides up, the stock likely re-rates given the depressed valuation and under-ownership. Historical beat/miss trend would clarify whether this is a serial beater or a show-me story.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$3.90 (undercuts the base), or if Aug 6 earnings miss or guide down on user engagement or UA cost pressures. Mobile gaming is a tough sector - Apple's IDFA changes have compressed margins industry-wide, and any commentary suggesting ongoing headwinds would pressure the stock despite a technical breakout.
ANALYSIS
Solid B-grade setup: base_tight 2.47 (acceptable), prox_52w 86.5 (breakout zone), rs_vs_spy +13.2 (outperforming), volume 2.16x, and a 16-day earnings catalyst. Cannot reach A because RS line is NOT at new high and volume is below the 2.5x+ threshold for explosive breakouts. The industry (mobile gaming) is not a favored secular theme, which adds caution. Strongest disconfirming evidence: no insider buying, and the sector faces structural headwinds (IDFA, competition from TikTok/short-form video). This is a tactical trade into the Aug 6 print, not a high-conviction hold. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$4.26 on vol >216% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.16x

